

Ennyah Digisound II DS601 MP3 Player

Compact all-in-one

The Ennyah DS601 measures just 88 x 32 x 20 mm. The body is metal, and it comes with the driver CD,



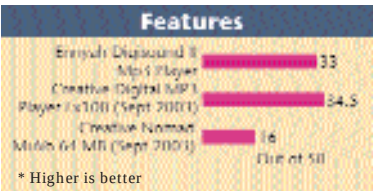
a USB extension cable, user manual, headphone with neck strap and one AAA battery. It can play MP3s and FM radio; it records voice and can be used to transport files.

The DS601 automatically creates a folder where all voice recordings are stored. Using the device for transporting files was easy, and the 26 x 96 mm LCD displays an animation of the file transfer procedure. We managed to transfer 50 MB of MP3s to the player in 1 minute and 33 seconds—the fastest we've seen in solid-state players.

Price: Rs 6,500 (approx)
Contact: Great World Tech Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-2389 2828
E-mail: sales@gtechworld.com
Web site: www.ennyah.com.tw

The sound was crisp and clear—the treble was good but the bass lacking. The single AAA battery lasted about 7 hours at normal use.

Overall, with 128 MB of storage and a price tag of Rs 6,500, this device comes across as great value for money. It even beats our previous winner—the Creative Nomad MuVo 64MB, which offers 64 MB storage for Rs 6,000.



SPECIFICATIONS

128 MB memory, supported formats: MP3, WMA, built-in LCD with white backlight, voice recording, FM tuner, FM recording, data storage, USB interface, dimensions: 88 x 32 x 20 mm, weight: 46 gms (without battery)

Ennyah Digisound II DS601 MP3 Player	
Performance	33
Features	34.5
Ease of use	16
Value for money	16

Samsung ML-1510 Laser Printer

The no-frills laser printer

The Samsung ML-1510 laser printer is remarkably small, and is lighter than most laser printers. The paper tray has a capacity of around 250 sheets. Printed output is either ejected from the top or from the rear tray.

There's no LCD display, only a large button on the top with two LEDs indicating the status and the toner-save feature. The printer has extensive support for all major distributions of Linux and MacOS.

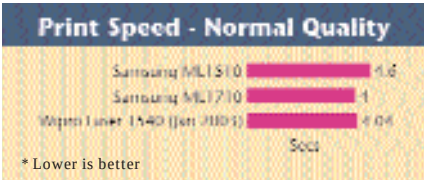
The accessories bundled include the driver CD, a 15-amp power cable and a USB cable.

In our speed test, it printed 13 pages per minute, which is one less than its claimed 14 p p m —



a shade slower than the Wipro Laser 1540 which is Rs 250 cheaper than the 1510. Though 17 seconds in the image test was amazing, it yielded a dismal 35 seconds in the combination document test. However, it did deliver better image quality than the Wipro Laser 1540. The MS-Word print test showed only a marginal difference in quality.

The clincher is the low price tag of Rs 11,000, making



it ideal for the SoHo segment, and those upgrading from older dot matrix printers.

SPECIFICATIONS

2 MB buffer, 13 ppm, USB 1.1 interface, paper sizes supported: A4, letter, transparencies, labels

Price: Rs 11,000
Contact: Samsung Electronics India Information & Telecommunication Ltd
Phone: 011-5151 1234
E-mail: farukh@samsungindia.com
Web site: www.samsungindia.com

Samsung ML-1510 Laser Printer	
Performance	1.6
Features	1
Build quality	4.06
Value for money	4.06

Western Digital WD2500JB Hard Drive

Huge and fast

The WD2500JB hard drive from Western Digital offers 7,200

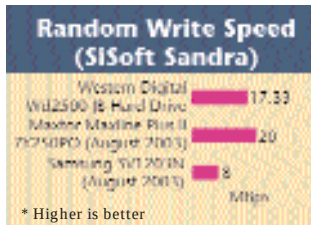


rpm speeds. This hard disk has three platters—each can store about 83 GB of data, with an 8 MB buffer.

The drive has a read burst speed of 70.1 MBps, as compared to 80 MBps for the Maxtor 250 GB drive. This can be attributed to the differences in interface; the Maxtor has an ATA133 interface as compared to Western Digital's ATA 100 interface. The random write speed of 17.33 MBps was also worse than the Maxtor's 20 MBps.

Price: Rs 17,500
Contact: Western Digital
Phone: 022-2588 4538
E-mail: ajay.kapure@wdc.com
Web site: www.wdc.com

Though the WD2500JB lags in terms of features and performance, it certainly came out well on the value for money front—with 6.84 paise per MB, as compared to 8.2 paise per MB that Maxtor had to offer for its 250 GB.



SPECIFICATIONS

Buffer Size: 8 MB, Read Seek Time (Average): 8.9 ms, Average Latency: 4.2 ms (nominal)

Western Digital WD2500JB Hard Drive	
Performance	17.33
Features	20
Build quality	8
Value for money	8